

Oliver Wehrens

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I'm a hands-on Software Engineer and Leader with over 20 years of experience. I led engineering as CTO and VP Engineering, most recently at Smava with six product teams across three locations, and was part of the management board at E-POST/DHL, where I ran a strategic programme with 100 developers in 11 teams. Today at Trusted Shops I lead three teams, took over product development for the company's most important new product and I'm building a new organizational unit. I still build myself: I deliver MVPs with Claude Code, train our teams in spec-driven development and drive its adoption as an internal standard. I also spent two years embedded in four companies as Associate Partner. All of that taught me how new ways of working stick: with working examples and standards people actually want to use.

Qualification

- **Leadership & Management:** Team Leadership across Sites, Strategic Planning, Change Management
- **Technical:** Software Engineering, Architecture, Cloud Technologies, Distributed Systems, Agentic AI Development (Claude Code, MCP, spec-driven development)
- **Business:** Alignment of Product Roadmap and Technology, Product Development incl. Customer Interviews, Operational Efficiency

Work Experience

MARCH 2025 – TODAY

Engineering Manager / Trusted Shops, Cologne

- Leading 3 teams (15 engineers) and building a new organizational unit for the future of Trusted Shops, responsible for tech, roadmap and agentic ways of working in product & tech, startup within the company
- Acted as Product Manager and Project Manager for 8+ months on top of my engineering role: took over product development of the company's most important new product, ran customer interviews, managed company stakeholders. Delivered the MVP in 5 months, presented in September 2025
- Preparing our product for agentic e-commerce: MCP server and agent API, prototypes and research on emerging agentic commerce standards and protocols
- Introduced spec-driven development as an internal standard: designed the workshop, train the teams, drive adoption
- Build MVPs of new services hands-on with Claude Code, slice product and roadmap into deliverables for the CEO vision
- Leveling up our Principal Engineers, set standards for how teams work in processes and tooling

Skills: Leadership, Product Development, AI-native Ways of Working, Strategy, Stakeholder Management

MAY 2023 – FEBRUARY 2025

Associate Partner / Tektit Consulting, Berlin

- Embedded engineering leadership in four client organizations (InternetX, Univention, Prosoz, Interflex/Allegion), working inside each organization with its own processes, stakeholders and constraints
- Streamlined processes with improved efficiencies by 20%, established project management and focus on critical milestones so the right features got built
- Built a company roadmap to focus the organization on the path to profitability
- Untangled build pipelines of 1,200 projects in Microsoft Azure into one consistent, faster build
- Focus areas: technology and product development, change management, agile transformation, leadership, strategy

Skills: Embedded Delivery, Change Management, Product Development, Strategy, Communication

SEPTEMBER 2021 – JANUARY 2023

VP Engineering / Smava, Berlin

- Responsible for 6 autonomous product development teams across three development sites, 40 people in direct leadership (network organization without team leads)
- Sole responsibility for engineering & IT after layoffs, increased developer efficiency by 30% with clear reporting and monitoring of work progress
- Drove the integration of Finanzcheck after the merger, promoting a network organization of autonomous teams

- Drove technical standardization, security and AWS development. Recruitment and resizing of teams

Skills: Multi-site Leadership, Change & Tech Management, Hiring

NOVEMBER 2019 – MAY 2021

CTO / Polyteia, Berlin

- Converted an existing MVP into a data platform, integrated 24 customers
- Defined ways of working and delivery, hired the development team, built a data team, hands-on coding in Python and SQL
- Built a Covid report/monitoring platform for schools in Schleswig-Holstein in 6 weeks

Skills: Leadership, Entrepreneurship, Software Engineering, Strategy, SQL

JUNE 2012 – OCTOBER 2019

Head of Architecture / E-POST – DHL, Berlin

Chief Software Engineer (2013–2014) · Principal Engineer (2012–2013)

- Project lead of the 12-month strategic programme “Digitale Kopie” with 100 developers in 11 teams, delivered on time
- Part of the management board, integration of E-POST Development GmbH into DHL Post (2017) and DHL IT Services (2019)
- Created the overall architecture and developed guidelines and standards for the entire organization

Skills: Architecture, Leadership, Change Management, Organizational Standards, Hiring

MAY 2008 – MAY 2012

Senior Developer / Hypoport, Berlin

- Built the Dutch mortgage platform incl. end-user UI, introduced CI/CD

OCTOBER 2003 – APRIL 2008

IT Analyst / Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge

In parallel with my MPI role: two jobs at the same time, commuting between Germany and the US

- Enabled scientists to leverage portal technology for computational physics. Advocate of the GridSphere project across Asia, Europe and North America

SEPTEMBER 1997 – APRIL 2008

Software Developer / System Administrator / Max Planck Institute, Potsdam

- Core developer of the GridSphere portal project, part of the EU-sponsored GridLab project and the German D-GRID effort
- Responsible for Silicon Graphics supercomputer and DEC/IRIX infrastructure (1997–2001)

Personal Products & AI Projects

- app.cozzuna.com: cookbook and shopping list app with AI recipe recognition, weekly planning and smart lists (iOS app with backend, in production)
- planningpoker.fyi: planning poker tool for sprint estimation, built during my product management time because I wanted a proper one.
- Podcast news aggregator (n.4004.fyi): transcribes selected AI podcasts and extracts the key insights, my daily tool for staying current on AI development
- Blog (owehehrens.com): writing about software development since 2009, lately about AI-supported product development workflows, what I learned building these products and AI-assisted development with Cursor and Claude Code

Education

Diplom Wirtschaftsinformatik, FHTW Berlin, September 1997

Other

I published articles in Java Magazin & Entwickler Magazin, gave talks at Berlin Expert Days, W-JAX and Architecture Gathering, and mentor at the Mentoring Club. I really enjoy cooking and can talk for hours about home automation.